Research Evolution

Edition A - unchanged baseline

The unchanged source is `edition-a/Edition_A.md`. The original Brightspace receipt must be retained separately by the student; do not overwrite the submitted baseline.

Edition B - current decision

The current conclusion remains **watch/defer**, but it is now supported by a linked five-year pro-forma, FCFF DCF, enterprise-to-equity bridge, scenario range, reverse DCF, peer policy, and validation checks.

Item	Edition A	Edition B	Primary driver	Evidence/test
Thesis/action	Watch/defer because valuation was unknown	Watch/defer because base value is 193.14 versus 221.70 market reference	Own analysis and new calculation	Final FCFF model and reverse DCF
Share convention	FY2026 diluted weighted-average EPS count flagged as unresolved	24,304m valuation-date common-share proxy used consistently and disclosed	Own reconciliation	Separate share-basis definition in README/source ledger
Cash-flow design	FCFF forecast planned	Five-year pro-forma drives FCFF and enterprise value	Course instruction and own model work	Balance, cash, and bridge checks
Downside/risk	Demand and margin risk identified	Low case: growth -5 points, margin -100 bp, WACC +75 bp, g -50 bp; 137.31/share	Own analysis	Causal low-case output
Peer evidence	Not researched	AMD P/E retained only as a qualified one-peer reference, not averaged	Peer policy and AI/fresh-eyes challenge	Week 4 source/peer record

The decision did not change from watch/defer because the new evidence both supports NVIDIA's operating momentum and shows that the market reference remains above the base FCFF result. AI assistance accelerated organization and challenge framing, but the filing inputs, peer-policy disposition, model tests, and decision remain subject to student verification and judgment.